



MOTOR VEHICLE TECHNICIAN

JOB DESCRIPTION

Motor vehicle technicians inspect faults and use computer-based tests to diagnose problems with a vehicle's mechanical or electrical systems, then repair, service, or replace any worn parts. This is a good profession for those who enjoy the challenge of dismantling, fixing, and maintaining mechanical systems.



SALARY

Novice technician ★★★★★

Senior technician ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Good opportunities for qualified technicians • Employers include car dealerships, garages, breakdown organizations, and freight and construction companies

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Motor vehicles • Mechanical systems • Engineering • Electronics • Physics • Mathematics • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Good school grades in science, mathematics, and English are usually required for trainee positions and vocational courses.



LIFESTYLE Most employees work full-time, but shift-work, overtime, and on-call hours—for breakdown services especially—are often required.



LOCATION The job is usually based in a workshop. Breakdown work requires travel as well as performing repairs outdoors and in all weather conditions.



THE REALITIES The job can be physically tiring, messy, and potentially dangerous due to the heavy, dirty, and hazardous nature of vehicle parts.

CAREER PATHS

Technicians often specialize in a make of vehicle or type of repair, such as front-end mechanics—the suspension, steering, and wheels. Options for career progression include self-employment or changing roles, such as garage repair-work or managing the maintenance of a transportation firm's vehicles.

TRAINEE You can work as a trainee or apprentice motor vehicle technician, combining paid work with practical, on-the-job training.



COLLEGE GRADUATE You can gain a qualification before finding a job by taking a vocational course in motor vehicle technology. This will combine classroom instruction with workshop experience.

